inscribe it on coins alongside those of the Twelve Imāms, and work to diminish the power of the Aūzbegs. These commitments appear to have been a response to a demand, and they were likely imposed rather than voluntarily offered. Khwānd-amīr notes that when Ismā'īl fully grasped the significance of Babur's letter (indicating that his conditions for assistance had been accepted), he dispatched the troops under the three mentioned commanders.

Persian leaders recommended a direct move on Bukhārā and Samarkand, a plan that Babur's advisors supported. According to Ḥaidar, they argued that Bukhārā was then devoid of troops and filled with unprepared individuals. 'Ubaid Khān had taken refuge in Qarshī, and it was decided not to assault him but to proceed onward and camp one stage beyond the town. This plan was executed, and as scouts reported 'Ubaid Khān's departure from Qarshī and his hasty journey to Bukhārā, his own territory, swift and immediate pursuit followed. Over the span of 100 miles along the caravan road, they chased him into Bukhārā and beyond, compelling him and his garrison, as they fled, to surrender their plunder in the open expanse of Turkistān. Many sulṭāns had congregated in Samarkand, possibly including fugitives who had escaped from Pul-i-sangīn, such as Tīmūr, its governor. Overwhelmed by Babur's second triumph, they dispersed into Turkistān, thereby leaving him with an unobstructed path.

c) Samarkand re-occupied and relations with Ismā'īl Ṣafawī

At this point, Babur likely entertained the hope of being able to do away with his risky associates, as he dismissed them upon his arrival in Bukhārā, expressing gratitude and presenting them with gifts for their contributions. Ḥaidar, who was present during this period, specifies Bukhārā as the location for this event.[*] From Bukhārā, Babur proceeded to Samarkand. It was in mid-Rajab (corresponding to October of AD 1511), approximately ten months after departing from Kābul and after nine years of absence, that he re-entered the city. Samarkand was adorned for his reception, and the townspeople warmly welcomed him with great enthusiasm.[3]

Over the course of eight months, it became evident that Babur was powerless to maintain his control against the formidable forces aligned against him. These forces consisted of the consolidated military might of the Aūzbegs, driven by Sunnī zeal, intensified by their aversion to being under the rule of a Shī'a suzerain. Both as a Sunnī himself and as someone who had not previously acknowledged a suzerain, Babur found himself in an uncomfortable position. He was aware of the dangers inherent in his alliance with Ismā'īl. Furthermore, he recognized that these risks were escalating as news of Ismā'īl's fervent